Your 20-Minute Exploration, Grades 6–8

Start here

Choose one domain, try its activity as a learner, then plan how you will use it. Timing is advice; tick each activity you try.

One link opens the tour, the exploration, the lesson and the Site Guide: **The Language Page: Start Here** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/start

How to use each activity, and every activity on the site: **Activity Guide** /guides/activity-guide.pdf · **Site Directory** /guides/site-directory.pdf

The 20 minutes

0–2 min	**Choose one focus.** Listening, speaking, reading or writing.
2–9 min	**Try one activity.** Complete a short sample as a learner and try one support.
9–14 min	**Adapt it.** Fill in the planning card.
14–18 min	**Rehearse classroom use.** Explain it to a partner or rehearse your directions.
18–20 min	**Leave with one next step.** Activity, class, support, and when.

Web addresses below begin with thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab

Activity	What to try	One classroom use
Listening ☐ **Recycling Benefits: Listen for the Main Idea** /Listening/B/main-idea-match-b	Press “Listen.” Try “Slower,” then “Hear question.” Choose an answer, say how sure you are, then press “Check my answer.”	Mini-lesson: play the statement, students choose the main idea, then say the detail that proves it.
Speaking ☐ **The Busy Hallway** /voice/ladder/school-hallway	Go to Step 3. Tap “Hear Lina first,” then say your own answer aloud using the sentence frame.	Partner warm-up: each student says Step 3 to a partner, who listens for one reason.
Reading ☐ **Saving Water: Find the Main Idea** /Reading/A/read-main-idea	Read the short text. Open “Word help” for any word you want to check. Choose an answer, say how sure you are, then press “Check my answer.”	Literacy block: read, choose the main idea, then underline the sentence that proves it.
Writing ☐ **Language Upgrade Lab** /scaffold/language-upgrade?item=lu68-argue-phones	Choose “Start with this help,” write one improved sentence, press “Check my work,” then fix one thing it names.	Exit ticket: every student revises one sentence, then partners compare the exact word each chose.

Plan it

My students will practice...

Students will say or write...

I will offer this support...

I will look or listen for...

After feedback, students will try again by...

Say it to a partner: I will use ___ with ___ so students can ___. First, I will ___. Then students will ___.

Featured Lesson: Speak, Write, Improve

Safer Hallways, 10 minutes. Students will explain one change and support it with a reason and an example, first aloud and then in writing.

> **Say to students:** “The hallway gets crowded between classes. Explain one change the school could make so students get to class safely, and give a reason.” **Frame:** One change the school could make is ___. This would help because ___. For example, ___.

Open the lesson page	Open the activity	Site Guide
/start/lesson	/voice/ladder/school-hallway	/site-guide

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1. **Notice** 1 minute. Show the picture. Ask: “What do you see? What problem could happen here?” Take two quick answers.
2. **Speak** 2 minutes. Read the prompt. Partners take turns answering with the frame. The listener holds up one finger for the change and two for the reason.
3. **Write** 3 minutes. Students turn what they said into two or three written sentences. Allow home-language notes first.
4. **Improve** 2 minutes. Give one cue only: “Add an example that starts with For example.” Students add it and read the new version once.
5. **Share** 2 minutes. Two or three students read the revised response and say what they added.

Sample learner work

First response

The school should make the hallway bigger. It is too crowded.

Improved response

One change the school could make is to put arrows on the floor so everyone walks the same way. This would help because students would not run into each other. For example, a student with a heavy backpack could get to class without being pushed.

The improved response adds a clear change, a reason and an example.

One feedback cue	Add an example that starts with “For example.”
Quick check	Ask students to point to their change, their “because,” and their “For example.” Count how many have all three.
Follow-up	Students write one change for another school place (the lunch line or bus loading) with the same three parts, then try the Language Upgrade Lab.

Three support choices Supports fade; the task stays the same.

More support

- Vocabulary: crowded, hallway, rule, safely, bump into, walk on the right, arrows.
- Visual reference: the hallway picture stays on screen.
- Oral rehearsal: say it twice with a partner before writing.
- Sentence frame: One change the school could make is ___. This would help because ___.

Some support

- Optional connectors: because, so, also, for example.
- Reason prompt: “Why would this help?”

Greater independence

- Write a fuller explanation with two reasons.
- Choose a more exact word for “crowded” or “rule.”
- Answer a classmate who disagrees: “Some students think … However, …”

These are practical supports, not WIDA levels or alignments. Students may plan in their home language before they say or write in English.